

benefited, and even lived, specifically because of the ACA. Scott is able to have health insurance now only because of it; otherwise his cancer would've been considered a preexisting condition that precluded him from getting insurance. But even with insurance, unexpected medical expenses can create lifelong debt.

In an article for *Jacobin* magazine, "Ending the Empathy Gap," writer Clio Chang argues that if we decide that only certain people deserve government benefits like health care (or welfare or even schooling), then we've lost the meaning behind coexisting in a society.

The point is that everyone should get benefits—not just the people we like or think deserve them—and that's what's so scary about crowdfunding medical expenses. You have to prove you're likable in order to live. Clio's argument is that morality, work ethic, and fan base should not decide who lives and who dies. We are not in the Hunger Games.

It's happening, though. Reporter Anne Helen Peterson wrote an incredible piece for *Buzzfeed News*, "The Real Peril of Crowdfunding Health Care," which profiled ill people who have to curate a brand on sites like GoFundMe or YouCaring to stay alive. So if you do get sick, you better also be good at marketing.

As Peterson writes about one of her subjects, "And while her story is tragic, when she first posted it, it wasn't dramatic enough to go viral on crowdfunding sites filled with similar pleas for help. She's young, but she's not an adorable child; she's extremely sick, but not with a disease that most people understand. Which isn't to suggest that her story, or her life, isn't worthy. But her situation highlights many of the underlying issues with a new-found reliance on crowdfunding as a social safety net."

We used to be able to rely on our government for these basic public needs, but now? Nope. I donate to a website that helps teachers buy supplies for their classrooms. I gave with one click so my friend's sister could see a lung cancer specialist in Florida. You need friends, a social-media-savvy niece, or a marketing strategy for the things you used to pay taxes to ensure. It's embarrassing to have to launch a GoFundMe for health care—both for the sick person and for our society.